MONTHLY UPDATE

Zimbabwe: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Strategies, plans and policies

POSTAL AND COURIER SERVICES POLICY

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT, Postal and Courier Services ministry set 2030 as the deadline to turn the country's more than 250 post offices into Smart Post Offices, announced at a postal conference in Harare on 18 September 2026. The plan includes a ring-fenced fund for Zimpost's universal service obligation, AI parcel tracking and drone delivery. A postal policy and an e-commerce bill are being drafted.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera set out a three-phase plan for the postal and courier sector at its annual conference: ring-fencing the Universal Service Fund, then Smart Post Offices by 2030 with AI, drones and e-commerce, then strategic equity partnerships. A Postal and Telecommunications Amendment Bill is before Parliament and an E-Commerce and E-Transactions Bill is being drafted.

REGULATOR'S COMMERCIAL ARRANGEMENTS UNIT

- **ICT Minister Mavetera directs Potraz to establish unit to police operator deals** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister asked the telecommunications regulator to consider a dedicated unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements, mediate disputes and enforce active infrastructure sharing. She also wants the Universal Service Fund to reach every marginalised ward and the regulator's sharing and tower-relocation directives evaluated in 2027.

POSTAL AND COURIER SECTOR TRANSFORMATION IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **Government gives postal sector 90 days for transformation plan** — The Herald, 12 October 2026

Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed plan for the postal and courier sector to 2030, with quarterly reporting. She also directed operators to comply with the Cyber and Data Protection Act and required pilots of artificial intelligence and drones to carry a named lead, a timetable and measurable benefits.

Legislation and regulation

STATUTORY INSTRUMENT ON E-HAILING SERVICES

- **InDrive, Bolt providing affordable, dignified services – says government, as e-hailing services get five-month reprieve** — NewZimbabwe, 9 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's Cabinet granted e-hailing platforms including Bolt, InDrive and Tap & Go a five-month moratorium, Information Minister Soda Zhemu announced on 9 September 2026. During it the government will develop a self-regulating framework for drivers and passenger safety and register the businesses, with a view to bringing platforms and drivers into the tax net.

E-COMMERCE AND E-TRANSACTIONS BILL

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data protection

NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION POLICY 2026-2030

- **Zim rolling out gateways, teacher and parents training in line with the Child Online Protection Policy** — New Ziana, 10 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister, Tatenda Mavetera, told the National Assembly on 9 September 2026 that the National Child Online Protection Policy is moving to implementation. A committee with the education and social welfare ministries is installing content gateways on public free Wi-Fi and school networks so children reach only age-appropriate material; a social media ban would need further consultation.

ADMINISTRATIVE SANCTIONS UNDER THE DATA PROTECTION ACT

- **The inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre (SIRDC), Zimbabwe, 23 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator POTRAZ held a national workshop on guidelines under the Cyber and Data Protection Act and on amendments to Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on administrative fines, marking the first Africa Data Protection Day on 21 September 2026, according to the research centre SIRDC. The text and status of the amendments are not given.

Regional collaboration

NETWORK OF AFRICAN DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITIES MEMBERSHIP

- **POTRAZ Joins Continental Partners to Commemorate Inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — TechnoMag, 22 September 2026

> Zimbabwe's regulator POTRAZ, which acts as the country's data protection authority, marked the first Africa Data Protection Day on 21 September. The day commemorates the 2016 founding of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, which now has 34 members and in which POTRAZ is second vice-president.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

> PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEE OF THE FUTURE

- **DR. B. Chirume Appointed To Parliamentary Committee Of The Future As Zimbabwe Eyes 30-Year Digital Roadmap** — TechnoMag, 4 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT ministry said its permanent secretary, Beaullah Chirume, has been appointed to Parliament's Committee of the Future, which plans a 30-year outlook tied to Vision 2056. TechnoMag reports the committee is expected to plan for AI, cybersecurity and rural connectivity, and notes ZIMPOST's 300-plus offices are being repurposed for digital inclusion.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Energy · Cybersecurity

Connectivity

> RETIREMENT OF THE 3G NETWORK

- **Econet says to phase out 3G by end of 2027** — NewsDay, 10 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's largest operator will shut down its 3G network by the end of December 2027, its chief executive said, retiring 3G before 2G because 2G remains widely used in rural areas by subscribers with basic feature phones. The operator is accelerating investment in 4G and 5G.

> ECONET INFRACO

- **Econet InfraCo - Unaudited Abridged Interim Financial Statements for the Half Year Ended 31 August 2026** — Econet Infrastructure Company Limited, 1 October 2026

  Econet InfraCo, the tower, power and property arm of Econet Wireless Zimbabwe listed on the Victoria Falls Stock Exchange, reported unaudited revenue of US$70.1 million and profit of US$13.7 million for the six months to 31 August 2026, with no interim dividend. It said solar power and AI-based fuel management cut fuel use by 30%, and construction began on a planned 100MW solar farm.

- **Econet InfraCo reports solid maiden half-year results after VFEX listing** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 4 October 2026

  Econet InfraCo, the tower, power and property company listed in Victoria Falls, reported revenue of US$70.1 million and EBITDA of US$29.0 million for the six months to 31 August 2026, its first half-year results since listing.

Energy

> ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE FUEL MANAGEMENT ON TOWER SITES

- **Econet InfraCo - Unaudited Abridged Interim Financial Statements for the Half Year Ended 31 August 2026** — Econet Infrastructure Company Limited, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Cybersecurity

> CYBERSECURITY OF INDUSTRIAL CONTROL NETWORKS AT A PLATINUM MINE

- **Rockwell secures Mimosa Mine control networks in Zimbabwe** — Tech Africa, 2 September 2026

  Rockwell Automation said on 1 September 2026 that it had completed a cybersecurity and modernisation project at Zimbabwe's Mimosa platinum mine with local distributor Mine Elect. The work covered network architecture, segmentation of control systems, and controls on system access, data transfer, monitoring and recovery. No contract value, timeline or prompting incident is given.

INVESTIGATION INTO WHATSAPP BUSINESS ACCOUNT TAKEOVERS

- **Govt probes mass WhatsApp takeovers in Zimbabwe** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera said her ministry has opened a multi-agency investigation, including the police Cyber Crime Division, into a wave of WhatsApp Business account takeovers. It will examine whether personal or financial data was compromised and the role of SMS termination aggregators, and is engaging Meta and the affected mobile operator.

CYBERSECURITY FRAMEWORK FOR CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE PROTECTION

- **POTRAZ moves to tighten cybersecurity for critical infrastructure** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 15 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator is developing a Cybersecurity Framework for Critical Infrastructure Protection, its draft regulation cited as a governance example at a regulators' follow-up meeting in Nairobi. The regulator also restated that data controllers must be licensed under the Cyber and Data Protection Act.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

REGIONAL CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP

- **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Customs administrations of Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026, hosted by the South African Revenue Service and convened by TradeMark Africa. The aim is to share trade data before consignments reach the border, building on existing Zambia-Malawi and Zambia-Zimbabwe links.

MOBILE MONEY VALIDATION AGAINST THE CIVIL REGISTRY

- **RBZ shuts down ghost wallets** — Business Times, 10 September 2026

  The Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe has closed ghost, fictitious and duplicate mobile money wallets after linking the Civil Registry's national database to mobile-money subscriber records, Business Times reported on 10 September 2026. The number of wallets closed, the operators affected and when the linkage began are not given.

- **RBZ closes loopholes on mobile money illicit financial flows, fraud** — The Herald, 14 September 2026

> The Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe says all mobile money providers are now linked to the national Civil Registry, allowing identity checks at sign-up and in ongoing KYC reviews. Governor John Mushayavanhu said operators completed a customer verification exercise by the 30 June 2026 deadline set in his February monetary policy statement, and all wallets were rescreened against the registry.

Digital Payments and Fintech

> INTERMEDIATED MONEY TRANSFER TAX (IMTT)

- **Zimbabwe: Country Growth and Jobs Report (P512930)** — World Bank Group, 2 September 2026

  The World Bank's Country Growth and Jobs Report for Zimbabwe recommends considering phasing out the 2% Intermediate Money Transfer Tax, beginning with ZiG transactions. It records mobile money use by 63% of the population and digital retail transactions of USD 5.9 billion in the second quarter of 2025, and notes the January 2026 cut of the ZiG rate to 1.5%.

- **World Bank warns Zim** — Business Times (Zimbabwe), 17 September 2026

  The World Bank has urged Zimbabwe to reform its Intermediated Money Transfer Tax, saying the levy on electronic transactions discourages digital payments, weakens financial intermediation and pushes activity towards cash, Business Times reported on 17 September 2026. Banks and businesses are calling for the tax to be abolished or cut. Only the article's opening paragraph is available.

> FREQUENT TRAVELLER EXPRESS PASS TOLL PRE-PAYMENT

- **Checking Your ZINARA Frequent Traveller Express Pass (FTEP) Balance** — TechnoMag, 3 September 2026

  The Zimbabwe National Roads Administration lets holders of its Frequent Traveller Express Pass, a prepaid toll facility, check their remaining trips on WhatsApp by sending 'Zinara' and the vehicle registration number to +263 771 288 940. The pass is for drivers using toll plazas at least 15 times a month, who buy bundles of 15 to 25 trips.

> DIGITAL FOREIGN-EXCHANGE TRADING SYSTEM

- **Zimbabwe says single-currency switch hinges on market conditions** — NewZimbabwe (Bloomberg), 16 September 2026

  The Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe will introduce a digital foreign exchange trading system in the fourth quarter of 2026 after World Bank peer review, governor John Mushayavanhu told bankers in Harare. He said the move to the ZiG as sole currency will depend on single-digit inflation and three to six months of import cover; cover currently stands at about 1.8 months.

> INVOICEX INVOICE-DISCOUNTING MARKETPLACE

- **Zimbabwe Stock Exchange launches InvoiceX 48-hour invoice discounting market** — BCR Publishing, 24 September 2026

  The Zimbabwe Stock Exchange opened InvoiceX, a regulated invoice-discounting market run under the Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange, for invoices of US$1,000 to US$1.5 million. Once a buyer authenticates an invoice, licensed banks and microfinance lenders bid on the discount rate, with supplier payment targeted within 48 hours and platform fees of 0.65% of the transaction.

> REAL-TIME PAYMENTS SYSTEM ON INDIA'S UPI TECHNOLOGY

- **Zimbabwe eyes India’s UPI tech for national payments network; NPCI talks may wrap by October 31** — Moneycontrol, 6 October 2026

Zimbabwe's central bank is negotiating with NPCI International to build a real-time payments system on India's UPI technology, linking banks, mobile-money operators and fintechs. The governor told Bloomberg an agreement is possible by 31 October 2026; cross-border payments and remittances are not part of the first deployment.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM PARTICIPATION

- **CEO Africa Roundtable: Zimbabwe processes $5.8 million a month through PAPSS as local currency settlement takes hold** — The Herald, 8 October 2026

  Afreximbank said Zimbabwe is processing US$5.8 million a month through the pan-African payment and settlement system. Yuan clearing is being brought onto the platform through its link to China's interbank system.

Registries

STATUTORY INSTRUMENT 76 OF 2025 ON SECURITISED DEEDS

- **Unvalidated Title Deeds To Lose Formal Recognition in 11 Months** — Open Parly ZW, 11 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's justice minister Ziyambi Ziyambi told Parliament that the Digital Land Administrative Platform becomes the sole authoritative property register when the title-deed validation period ends in July 2027. Unvalidated paper deeds will then not be usable to sell or transfer land, though ownership is not lost. Validation costs US$215 including fees and VAT.

NATIONAL MSME DATABASE

- **Gvt Moves to Create National Database for Small Businesses** — 263Chat, 13 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's small-enterprise development corporation said a national database of micro, small and medium enterprises has reached minimum-viable-product stage, with an online registration portal in development. Talks are under way to link it to the revenue authority and the procurement regulator.

Sectoral management information systems

LABORATORY INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **GP4382002 ZWE Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS)** — UNGM, 14 September 2026

  The UN Development Programme posted tender GP4382002 on the UN Global Marketplace for a company to implement a laboratory information management system in Zimbabwe. A pre-bid conference was held online on 10 September 2026. No budget, scope or closing date is given in the notice.

- **Govt takes diagnostics closer to rural communities** — Zimbabwe Situation (source: The Herald), 23 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's health ministry said on 23 September 2026 that its Laboratory Information Management System is running at 117 main laboratories and linked to lower-level ones, allowing results to be sent electronically, including by SMS. The national laboratory plan for 2025–2030 aims to extend it to 80% of health facilities, and it is to connect with the Impilo electronic health records platform.

INTEGRATED ELECTRONIC CASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Electronic Case Management System (IECMS) brings justice closer to Gweru residents** — The Chronicle (via Herald), 26 September 2026

Zimbabwe's Judicial Service Commission is extending its Integrated Electronic Case Management System to magistrates' courts in Midlands and Mashonaland West on 1 October 2026, ahead of Harare and Bulawayo by year-end. The system, begun in 2022, already covers the Constitutional, Supreme and Labour Courts and the High Court; a public awareness event was held in Gweru.

- **Paperless courts spread to Midlands, Mashonaland West** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's Judicial Service Commission took its electronic case management system live in Midlands and Mashonaland West provinces on 1 October, after installing recording and transcription machines and issuing computers to court staff. Litigants and lawyers can file and follow cases online.

POLICE CRIME MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **ZRP pilots digital crime reporting system developed by Harare Institute of Technology at Warren Park Police Station** — The Herald, 8 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's home affairs minister told the National Assembly that a crime management system built by the Harare Institute of Technology is running as a proof of concept at Warren Park and a few other police stations. Reporting crime by mobile phone is to follow, and wider deployment depends on the test.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SMART POST OFFICES PROGRAMME

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ELECTRONIC TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Electronic traffic system being finalised** — Zimbabwe Situation, 13 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's police said logistics for an Electronic Traffic Management System were being finalised. The system is linked to the vehicle and civil registries to identify offenders and issue penalties electronically.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Rural digital data capture

DIGITAL HEALTH SITES IN POST OFFICES

- **ZimSmart converts ZimPost offices into digital health clinics** — The Herald, 9 October 2026

  ZimSmart Villages is converting parts of Zimbabwe Postal Services offices into nurse-staffed digital health clinics with point-of-care diagnostics and small dispensaries, and uses container clinics where there is no post office. The company told a conference in Bulawayo it has 28 sites connected through Starlink and NetOne and has reached 118,000 people.

Technology

AI · Innovation ecosystem

AI

OPERATOR INDIGENOUS-LANGUAGE CUSTOMER CHATBOTS

- **Econet Ai nears completion of Ndebele-speaking chatbot** — CITE Zimbabwe, 6 September 2026

  Econet Ai, a subsidiary of Econet Wireless Zimbabwe, said its Ndebele-speaking customer-support chatbot will be phased in from September 2026 and be fully conversational by the end of the year. Its Shona chatbot Yamurai already handles more than 70% of enquiries alongside about 600 contact-centre staff; Tonga, Swahili, Mandarin and French are planned.

SMART TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (ZRP SMART POLICING PROGRAMME)

- **Govt pursues traffic violators as 4m offences caught on camera** — Zimbabwe Situation (source: Herald), 27 September 2026

  Harare's AI-powered traffic cameras had recorded more than four million violations by the end of September 2026, up from 2.3 million in mid-August, and Zimbabwe's police have begun calling offenders in to pay fines after verification, reported on 27 September. Twenty cameras are installed under the first phase of a home affairs programme with TelOne, and more than 300 are planned for the capital.

Innovation ecosystem

BEYOND-VISUAL-LINE-OF-SIGHT MEDICAL DRONE DELIVERIES

- **Zimbabwe clears drones to deliver vaccines, blood and medicines** — NewZimbabwe, 22 September 2026

  The Civil Aviation Authority of Zimbabwe approved Drone Solutions Zimbabwe to fly beyond-visual-line-of-sight medical deliveries using Kite Aero's KITE aircraft, moving from demonstration flights completed in August 2026 to daily operations. The service carries vaccines, blood, pathology samples and medicines, with deliveries taking about 30 minutes. The date of the approval is not given.

Capacity

Training and skills · Research institutions

Training and skills

RURAL AI, DIGITAL AND INNOVATION HUB AT NYAMURORO VOCATIONAL TRAINING CENTRE

- **UNDP Partners Gvt To Launch First Rural AI, Digital and Innovation Hub at Nyamuroro VTC in Gokwe** — TechnoMag, 29 September 2026

  UNDP, Zimbabwe's youth ministry and Uncommon launched the country's first rural AI, digital and innovation hub at Nyamuroro Vocational Training Centre in Gokwe. The solar-powered hub uses Starlink and is enrolling 50 young people in a free one-year bootcamp from September 2026, targeting 3,000 learners and 300 teachers. No cost is given.

Research institutions

NATIONAL DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES POLICY RESEARCH PROGRAMME

- **Call for policy research proposals: National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme (DTPRP)** — Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority of Zimbabwe, Research Council of Zimbabwe and Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, 7 September 2026

Zimbabwe's telecommunications regulator, POTRAZ, with the Research Council of Zimbabwe and the Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, invited policy research proposals under a National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme. Priority areas include AI governance, data governance and sovereignty, platform regulation, connectivity and innovation policy; proposals close on 3 October 2026 and applicants are notified by 23 October.

- **POTRAZ National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme 2026: Call for Policy Research Proposals** — ApplyNOW (POTRAZ, RCZ and SIRDC call), 9 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority, with the Research Council of Zimbabwe and the Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, called for policy research proposals under a National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme, closing on 3 October 2026. The five priority areas include AI governance, data governance and cybersecurity, platform regulation and connectivity policy. No funding amount is given.

Inclusion

Access to services

Access to services

DIGITAL SKILLS TRAINING FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

- **Zimbabwe expands ICT skills support for teachers with visual impairments** — Digital Watch Observatory, 3 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator, POTRAZ, held a five-day ICT skills workshop in Chiredzi for 37 teachers with visual impairments, their assistants and aides from all ten provinces. The Internet Society Zimbabwe Chapter ran the training, which covered assistive technologies and accessible digital platforms.

INTERNET AND DATA TRAFFIC

- **Zimbabwe's internet traffic jumps 57%** — ITWeb Africa, 4 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's internet and data traffic rose 57.28% in the first quarter of 2026, the regulator reported, attributing it to faster LTE and 5G deployment, rising smartphone adoption and data-hungry applications. Operators added 13 5G base stations in the quarter to reach 379, covering 18.94% of the population, and deployed 161 further LTE sites; mobile internet and data was the largest revenue contributor at 46.34% of quarterly operator revenue.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

US / hyperscaler activities

BILATERAL HEALTH COOPERATION MEMORANDUM

- **A data-sharing clause derailed US-Zimbabwe health talks. Now all funding ends this month** — The Independent (AP wire, by Farai Mutsaka), 25 September 2026

  The US Embassy in Harare said on 25 September 2026 that US funding for Zimbabwe's health programmes ends at the end of September, after Zimbabwe declined a bilateral health memorandum. Zimbabwe objected in part to a requirement to share sensitive health data, including virus samples. Ambassador Pamela Tremont said relations would shift to trade and investment.

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